

to holding it in your hands, no matter how still your hands are. Just make sure you don't press any of the buttons on the side of the phone when you keep it on a surface. That can be really frustrating.

But of course, the best way to stabilize the camera is by using a tripod. You get tripod mounts these days for phones that can accommodate a large variety of phones and let you use any old tripod with them. You could also consider investing in a Gorilla Pod as it is more portable and more suitable for use with a smartphone than a full size tripod.

With video recording you have a few more things to remember. Just as with photos, camera shake affects videos as well and gets recorded into it, which may not be noticeable while shooting but can be jarring when you watch these videos later on a bigger screen. To solve this problem, many of the high end smartphones these days come with either digital image stabilization or optical image stabilization. The former may or may not give good results depending upon how good the software is. What it does do, however, is cut into your field of view when you activate it, so if you think you won't be needing video stabilization, like say if you have support, then disabling it from the settings will gain you a wider field of view.

Optical image stabilization is free from this nonsense and usually also works a lot better than digital image stabilization. If you have a phone with OIS, you are bound to get smoother videos but it is still recommended to keep the phone relatively steady.

When you're shooting a video, you must be careful not to block the microphones on the side. Most people hold the phone by its sides while shooting and this can block the mics placed there. They are there to give you a stereo sound effect and blocking them not only reduces the effect but also dulls the audio quality. So make sure you locate the mics on your phone and make sure you don't block them while shooting a video.

One last thing to remember while shooting a video, and this one is very important, is to always shoot in landscape mode. Videos are meant to be watched horizontally. Our eyes are horizontally placed. Monitors and televisions are horizontally designed. Cinema screens are horizontally designed. So videos should also be shot in landscape mode. It might seem fine when you're recording or watching a portrait video on your phone because a phone can be held in any orientation but you can't do that with your monitor or TV. So don't be the person who holds the phone in portrait to shoot vertical videos. Nobody likes that person.